

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Forest Types and Forest Rights Act - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Forest Types and Forest Rights Act	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — FOUR FOREST VOCABULARIES AND ECOLOGICAL DRIVERS Mechanism chain: Four forest vocabularies - Ecological type drivers
02	FOUNDATION — WET EVERGREEN TO THORN SEQUENCE Mechanism chain: Wet to dry sequence Qualified use: Use the
03	FOUNDATION — MONTANE SUB-ALPINE AND ALPINE ZONATION Mechanism chain: Montane zonation Qualified use: Map altitude
04	CORE — RESERVED PROTECTED VILLAGE AND UNCLASSIFIED FORESTS Mechanism chain: Legal forest categories Qualified use: Name each
05	CORE — RESERVED VERSUS PROTECTED PERMISSION LOGIC Technically, CORE — Reserved versus Protected permission logic is
06	CORE — FOREST COVER AND RECORDED FOREST AREA FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership
07	CORE — TREE COVER BOUNDARY Mechanism chain: Tree-cover boundary Qualified use: Keep
08	CORE — FRA HISTORICAL-INJUSTICE PURPOSE Mechanism chain: FRA purpose Qualified use: Frame FRA as
09	CORE — SCHEDULED TRIBE OTFD CUTOFF AND ELIGIBILITY The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an
10	CORE — INDIVIDUAL FOREST RIGHTS An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or
11	CORE — COMMUNITY RIGHTS AND COMMUNITY FOREST RESOURCE RIGHTS Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing.
12	CORE — HABITAT AND SPECIAL RIGHTS Mechanism chain: Habitat and special rights Qualified use: Identify
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — RECOGNITION PROCEDURE AND SECTION 4(5) Mechanism chain: Recognition procedure Qualified use: Trace Gram
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — SECTION 3(2) COMMUNITY FACILITIES The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — RIGHTS CONSERVATION AND AUDITED PYQ BOUNDARY Mechanism chain: Rights and conservation - Audited PYQ boundary

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Four forest vocabularies?

A. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. B. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. C. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. D. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category.

Answer: A. Explanation: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Four forest vocabularies?

A. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. B. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. C. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Four forest vocabularies without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. B. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. C. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Four forest vocabularies?

A. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. B. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. C. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. D. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.

Answer: D. Explanation: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Ecological type drivers?

A. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. C. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: A. Explanation: Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Ecological type drivers?

A. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. B. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. C. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Ecological type drivers without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. B. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. C. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Ecological type drivers?

A. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. B. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. C. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. D. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression.

Answer: D. Explanation: Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Wet to dry sequence?

A. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. B. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. C. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. D. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Wet to dry sequence?

A. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. C. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Wet to dry sequence without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. B. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. C. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. D. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Wet to dry sequence?

A. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. D. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Montane zonation?

A. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. B. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. C. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: A. Explanation: Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Montane zonation?

A. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. B. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. C. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. D. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.

Answer: B. Explanation: Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Montane zonation without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. D. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.

Answer: C. Explanation: Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Montane zonation?

A. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. D. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category.

Answer: D. Explanation: Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Legal forest categories?

A. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. B. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. C. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. D. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.

Answer: A. Explanation: Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Legal forest categories?

A. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. B. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. C. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. D. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Answer: B. Explanation: Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Legal forest categories without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. D. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership.

Answer: C. Explanation: Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Legal forest categories?

A. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: D. Explanation: Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Reserved-Protected reversal?

A. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. B. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. C. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. D. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Reserved-Protected reversal?

A. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. B. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. C. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. D. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Reserved-Protected reversal without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. D. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Reserved-Protected reversal?

A. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. B. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. C. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. D. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Forest-cover measurement?

A. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. D. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest.

Answer: A. Explanation: FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Forest-cover measurement?

A. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. B. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. C. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. D. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Answer: B. Explanation: FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Forest-cover measurement without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. B. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. C. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. D. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment.

Answer: C. Explanation: FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Forest-cover measurement?

A. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. B. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover

measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.

Answer: D. Explanation: FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Recorded forest area?

A. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. B. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. C. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. D. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Answer: A. Explanation: Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Recorded forest area?

A. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. B. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. C. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. D. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test.

Answer: B. Explanation: Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Recorded forest area without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. B. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. C. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. D. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights.

Answer: C. Explanation: Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Recorded forest area?

A. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. B. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest.

Answer: D. Explanation: Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Tree-cover boundary?

A. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. B. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. C. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. D. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Tree-cover boundary?

A. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. B. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Tree-cover boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. B. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. C. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. D. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Tree-cover boundary?

A. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. B. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies FRA purpose?

A. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. B. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. C. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. D. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of FRA purpose?

A. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. B. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses FRA purpose without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. B. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. C. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. D. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about FRA purpose?

A. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. B. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. C. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. D. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Eligibility and cutoff?

A. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. B. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. C. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. D. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Eligibility and cutoff?

A. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. B. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. C. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. D. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Eligibility and cutoff without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. B. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. C. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. D. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Eligibility and cutoff?

A. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. B. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. C. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. D. The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Individual forest right?

A. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. B. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights.

Answer: A. Explanation: An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Individual forest right?

A. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. B. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. C. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. D. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met.

Answer: B. Explanation: An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Individual forest right without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. B. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. C. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. D. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds.

Answer: C. Explanation: An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Individual forest right?

A. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. B. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. C. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. D. An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment.

Answer: D. Explanation: An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Community rights?

A. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. B. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. C. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. D. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met.

Answer: A. Explanation: Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Community rights?

A. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. B. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. C. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. D. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses Community rights without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. B. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. C. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. D. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Community rights?

A. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. B. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. C. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. D. Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights.

Answer: D. Explanation: Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Community forest resource right?

A. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. B. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. C. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. D. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met.

Answer: A. Explanation: A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Community forest resource right?

A. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. B. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. C. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. D. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.

Answer: B. Explanation: A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Community forest resource right without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. C. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. D. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project.

Answer: C. Explanation: A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Community forest resource right?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. C. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. D. A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights.

Answer: D. Explanation: A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Habitat and special rights?

A. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. B. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. C. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. D. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Habitat and special rights?

A. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. B. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. C. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. D. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Habitat and special rights without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. C. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. D. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not

inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Habitat and special rights?

A. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. B. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. C. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. D. The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Recognition procedure?

A. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. B. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. C. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. D. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project.

Answer: A. Explanation: The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Recognition procedure?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. C. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. D. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Answer: B. Explanation: The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Recognition procedure without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. C. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. D. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.

Answer: C. Explanation: The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Recognition procedure?

A. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. B. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. C. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. D. The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Section 4(5) safeguard?

A. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. B. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. C. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. D. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Section 4(5) safeguard?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. C. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. D. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Section 4(5) safeguard without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. B. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. C. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. D. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Section 4(5) safeguard?

A. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. B. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. C. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. D. The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Section 3(2) facilities?

A. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. B. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. C. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. D. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Section 3(2) facilities?

A. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. B. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. C. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. D. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Section 3(2) facilities without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. B. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. C. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. D. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Section 3(2) facilities?

A. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. B. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. C. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. D. The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records a conditional route for specified community development facilities on forest land through section 3(2), including area, tree-felling and Gram Sabha recommendation limits; it is not a general exemption for any project. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Rights and conservation?

A. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. B. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. C. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. D. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.

Answer: A. Explanation: FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Rights and conservation?

A. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. B. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. C. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. D. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks.

Answer: B. Explanation: FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Rights and conservation without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. B. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. C. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. D. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression.

Answer: C. Explanation: FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Rights and conservation?

A. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. C. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. D. FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter.

Answer: D. Explanation: FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. C. Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. D. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression.

Answer: A. Explanation: Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. B. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. C. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. D. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category.

Answer: B. Explanation: Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: Treat “Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?” as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?
Analysis: Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For “Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?”, explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. C. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. D. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or...”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:**

State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. B. The owner preserves the classic exam distinction: a Reserved Forest uses a more restrictive permission logic, whereas a Protected Forest does not create the same presumption; neither label is an ecological forest type. C. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. D. Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Answer: D. Explanation: Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat “Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?” as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?”.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in “Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For “Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?”, explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

AUDITED FOREST-TYPE, COVER AND FRA PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route seven Topic 11 demands: 2018 FRA critical wildlife habitat and Baiga rights; 2019 forest-cover ranking and bamboo as minor forest produce; 2020 GS-I forest resources; 2022 Miyawaki; 2023 deciduous trees; and 2024 native-tree identification. Objective keys are not inferred. The direct 2020 Mains demand receives a model route.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: match forest types to their rainfall/altitude driver and correctly distinguish Individual, Community and Community Forest Resource rights under the FRA.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the "historical injustice" rationale of the FRA is used to argue for tenure security as a precondition for sustainable forest management by local communities.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	30	Tree species native to India (cashew, papaya, red sanders)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Tree species native to India (cashew, papaya, red sanders)

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 6

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	98	Forest Rights Act Critical Wildlife Habitat and Baiga rights	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	33	Indian states ranked by forest cover percentage	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	55	Forest Rights Act bamboo as minor forest produce	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	GS-I	17	Status of India's forest resources and impact on climate change	Examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	Prelims GS-I	50	Miyawaki method for urban mini forest creation	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	3	Deciduous trees Jackfruit Mahua Teak classification	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Forest Rights Act Critical Wildlife Habitat and Baiga rights
- Indian states ranked by forest cover percentage
- Forest Rights Act bamboo as minor forest produce
- Status of India's forest resources and impact on climate change
- Miyawaki method for urban mini forest creation
- Deciduous trees Jackfruit Mahua Teak classification

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

11. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions on the FRA claims process should be solved by applying the Gram Sabha -> SDLC -> DLC sequence precisely.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "forest governance and tribal rights" should explicitly address the FRA-versus-wildlife-law coordination problem (Section 4) to demonstrate integrated understanding across GS-II and GS-III themes.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-I	17	Status of India's forest resources and impact on climate change	Examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Status of India's forest resources and impact on climate change

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q17 · 15 marks · 250 words

Demand: Examine the status of forest resources in India and their impact on climate change.

Status: Official-paper demand routed to Topic 11; this is a repository-authored model route, not an official UPSC solution.

Model solution: Four forest vocabularies: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Ecological type drivers:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Forest-cover measurement:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Recorded forest area:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Tree-cover boundary:** Tree cover is

measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Rights and conservation:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q17 · 15 marks · 250 words”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Four forest vocabularies: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Ecological type drivers:**

Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Forest-cover measurement:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Recorded forest area:**

Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Tree-cover boundary:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Rights and conservation:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Tree-cover boundary: Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Rights and conservation:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q17 · 15 marks · 250 words **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Examine the status of forest resources in India and their impact on climate change. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed to Topic 11; this is a repository-authored model route, not an official UPSC solution. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Four forest vocabularies: Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Ecological type drivers:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Forest-cover measurement:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Recorded forest area:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Tree-cover boundary:** Tree cover is

measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Rights and conservation:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 GS-I Q17 · 15 marks · 250 words”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish forest type, legal forest category, recorded forest area, forest cover and tree cover. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Ecological type drivers. **Named evidence/example:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.
- Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression.
- Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.
- FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.
- Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest.
- Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Ecological type drivers. **Named evidence/example:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish forest type, legal forest category, recorded forest area, forest cover and tree...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law

or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Ecological type drivers. **Named evidence/example:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction,

uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Ecological type drivers. **Named evidence/example:** Champion-Seth-style forest types organise vegetation mainly through climate, rainfall and altitude, while soils, fire, grazing and land-use history can modify local expression. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish forest type, legal forest category, recorded forest area, forest cover and tree...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the FRA eligibility and recognition route for Scheduled Tribes and OTFDs. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership.
- The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test.
- The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.
- The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the FRA eligibility and recognition route for Scheduled Tribes and OTFDs. Answer in...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and

social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain the FRA eligibility and recognition route for Scheduled Tribes and OTFDs. Answer in...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish individual, community, community forest resource and habitat rights. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community forest resource right. **Named evidence/example:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Habitat and special rights. **Named evidence/example:** The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment.
- Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights.
- A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights.
- The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access,

use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community forest resource right. **Named evidence/example:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Habitat and special rights. **Named evidence/example:** The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish individual, community, community forest resource and habitat rights. Answer in...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community forest resource right. **Named evidence/example:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Habitat and special rights. **Named evidence/example:** The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or

legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community forest resource right. **Named evidence/example:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Habitat and special rights. **Named evidence/example:** The Act also recognises habitat rights for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and pre-agricultural communities and traditional seasonal resource access where the statutory conditions are met. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish individual, community, community forest resource and habitat rights. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess how FRA procedure can reconcile tenure security and conservation. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rights and conservation. **Named evidence/example:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership.
- The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.
- The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds.
- FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rights and

conservation. **Named evidence/example:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how FRA procedure can reconcile tenure security and conservation. Answer in about 250...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rights and conservation. **Named evidence/example:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit,

exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Section 4(5) safeguard. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records section 4(5) as barring eviction or removal of eligible forest dwellers until recognition and verification are complete; it is a sequencing safeguard, not an automatic finding that every claim succeeds. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rights and conservation. **Named evidence/example:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess how FRA procedure can reconcile tenure security and conservation. Answer in about 250...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse the category errors that weaken Indian forest-governance debates. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wet to dry sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montane zonation. **Named evidence/example:** Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another.
- Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks.
- Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category.
- Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law.

- FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status.
- Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest.
- Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wet to dry sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montane zonation. **Named evidence/example:** Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Analyse the category errors that weaken Indian forest-governance debates. Answer in about 300...”, every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This

identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wet to dry sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montane zonation. **Named evidence/example:** Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four forest vocabularies. **Named evidence/example:** Forest type is an ecological classification, Reserved or Protected Forest is a legal category, recorded forest area is a government-record category, and forest or tree cover is a canopy measurement; none can substitute automatically for another. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wet to dry sequence. **Named evidence/example:** Tropical wet evergreen, semi-evergreen, moist deciduous, dry deciduous and thorn formations represent different ecological conditions; they are not canopy-density grades or legal protection ranks. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Montane zonation. **Named evidence/example:** Montane, sub-alpine and alpine vegetation reflect altitude and exposure in mountain systems; an elevational belt must not be presented as one nationwide legal forest category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Legal forest categories. **Named evidence/example:** Reserved Forest, Protected Forest and Village Forest arise through the Indian Forest Act framework, while unclassified forest is a record or administration expression; legal consequence must be checked from the applicable notification and law. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Forest-cover measurement. **Named evidence/example:** FSI forest cover uses remote-sensing canopy criteria across ownership and legal status; plantations or orchards can enter the cover measure, so canopy presence is not proof of natural-forest quality or legal forest status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter,

spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recorded forest area. **Named evidence/example:** Recorded forest area refers to land entered as forest in government records and may include different legal classes; degraded recorded forest can have little measured canopy, while measured cover can occur outside recorded forest. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Tree-cover boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tree cover is measured separately from forest cover under the applicable FSI methodology; combining them can describe canopy extent but cannot establish forest type, tenure or rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Analyse the category errors that weaken Indian forest-governance debates. Answer in about 300...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate FRA as a rights-restoration statute with conservation implications and implementation limits. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community forest resource right. **Named evidence/example:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological

mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rights and conservation. **Named evidence/example:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership.
- The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test.
- An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment.
- Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights.
- A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights.
- The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure.
- FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter.
- Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than

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Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate FRA as a rights-restoration statute with conservation implications and...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological

mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community forest resource right. **Named evidence/example:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Recognition procedure. **Named evidence/example:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Rights and conservation. **Named evidence/example:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Audited ledgers route forest type, forest cover, FRA, bamboo, critical wildlife habitat, Miyawaki and forest-resource demands to Topic 11; objective keys are not inferred, while the 2020 GS-I Mains demand receives a source-bounded model route. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual

cultivation rights. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** A community forest resource right is the community-level right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage a traditionally used community forest resource; it is distinct from both IFR and the wider set of community-use rights. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The claims route begins with the Gram Sabha and proceeds through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees; filing or recommendation is not the same as final recognition, and recognition is not assumed without the completed procedure. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** FRA assigns conservation responsibilities and CFR can support stewardship, but title recognition alone does not prove an ecological outcome; capacity, tenure security, monitoring and coordination still matter. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: FRA purpose. **Named evidence/example:** The Forest Rights Act, 2006 is a rights-recognition and historical-injustice statute for forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and eligible Other Traditional Forest Dwellers, not a blanket transfer of every forest to private ownership. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Eligibility and cutoff. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records occupation before 13 December 2005 and an additional three-generation or 75-year residence-and-dependence test for Other Traditional Forest Dwellers; Scheduled Tribe claimants do not face that OTFD generational test. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Individual forest right. **Named evidence/example:** An individual forest right concerns pre-existing habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation, subject to the Act's conditions and statutory ceiling; recognition does not authorise fresh encroachment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community rights. **Named evidence/example:** Community rights include specified customary uses such as grazing, access to water bodies and ownership, access, use or disposal of minor forest produce; they are not identical to individual cultivation rights. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial

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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate FRA as a rights-restoration statute with conservation implications and...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.